

ContexAi Research Desk · Sourced via Reuters, CNBC, Business Recorder, Express Tribune, Mettis Global, AGBI, Gulf News, S&P Global, Kitco, SBP & Regulatory Trackers · For the C-Suite & HNW Investor · **V** = verified vs licensed media/official portal · **EST.** = ContexAi desk estimate

KSE-100 V

171,944

▼ 0.40% Wed ·
-699 pts

S&P 500 V

▼ **0.48%**

Nasdaq -0.64% ·
Dow -0.77%

US 10Y / 2Y V

4.80 / 4.40

yields extend
higher, hawkish tilt

BRENT / WTI V

\$100.7 / \$96.2

Brent tops \$100 ·
Hormuz shock

GOLD V

\$4,400

+1.1% · silver
\$66.58

USD/PKR V

279.40

interbank · weaker
vs Tue's 277.37

01 Five Things You Need To Know To Start Your Day

KSE-100 FALLS A THIRD DAY

The benchmark shed **698.56 points (0.40%)** to close at 171,943.60 on Wednesday, extending its slide to nearly 3,400 points over three sessions as the widening US-Iran conflict and a surging oil tape kept sentiment fragile. The index swung between an intraday high of 173,174.18 and a low of 171,801.66; ready-market volume eased to **477.67 million shares** from Tuesday's 722.62 million as participation thinned. Selling stayed broad-based across banks, E&P, cement, fertiliser and OMC counters, with **UBL, OGDC, PPL, MCB, Fauji Fertiliser, Lucky Cement, Bank AL Habib and Attock Refinery** among the heaviest laggards. Sources: [Business Recorder](#), [The Nation](#). Sentiment: **risk-off, third straight loss**.

BRENT TOPS \$100 ON HORMUZ STRIKES

Brent crude breached **\$100/bbl** for the first time since July, settling near \$100.7 (+3%), while WTI climbed to about \$96.2, as the US and Iran traded their most intense strikes yet around the Strait of Hormuz — a corridor that carried roughly a fifth of global oil supply before the conflict, now down to a handful of daily transits. Iran's foreign minister said the strait will not reopen until Washington eases sanctions and pays reparations. Sources: [CNBC](#), [Al Jazeera](#). Sentiment: **supply-risk premium building**.

WALL STREET EXTENDS LOSING STREAK

US equities fell for a third straight session Wednesday: the S&P 500 slipped 0.48% to 7,636.46, the Dow dropped 0.77% to 52,381.02 and the Nasdaq eased 0.64% to 26,253.34, as rising oil prices and firm Treasury yields pressured margins and growth names. The 10-year Treasury hovered near **4.80%** and the 2-year near 4.40%, both close to multi-month highs, with traders positioning for a coin-flip 16 September FOMC decision under Chair Kevin Warsh. Sources: [CNBC](#), [Investrade](#). Sentiment: **broad-based risk-off**.

GULF NON-OIL MOMENTUM HOLDS

Away from the war premium, Gulf non-oil economies kept expanding: the UAE's S&P Global PMI rose to **55.3** in August, its strongest since December 2024, while Saudi Arabia's Riyadh Bank PMI climbed to **53.8**, a six-month high, even as export orders softened. OPEC+'s seven core producers held October quotas unchanged at their 6 September meeting, keeping the combined ceiling near 31.01m bpd as the group prioritises stability over added volume amid the Hormuz disruption. Sources: [Arab News](#), [OPEC](#). Sentiment: **resilient despite war premium**.

GOLD, SILVER EXTEND SAFE-HAVEN BID

Gold climbed back above **\$4,400/oz** (+1.1%), ending a three-session dip as a softer dollar and Middle East risk drove haven demand, while silver rose to **\$66.58/oz** (+1.2%). Both metals remain firmly inside their 2026 uptrend as investors hedge against a hawkish Fed and an unresolved Iran conflict. Sources: [CNBC](#), [Kitco](#). Sentiment: **firmer safe-haven bid**.

02 Regional Market & Economic Matrix

A. Local Market — Pakistan Focus

The KSE-100 fell for a third straight session, shedding 698.56 points (0.40%) to close at 171,943.60 on Wednesday — a nearly 3,400-point slide over three days — as the widening US-Iran conflict and a surging oil tape drove broad-based selling in banks, E&P, cement, fertiliser and OMC names, led by **UBL, OGDC, PPL, MCB, Fauji Fertiliser and Lucky Cement**. Ready-market volume eased to 477.67 million shares from Tuesday's 722.62 million. On the policy front, the government's **Sovereign Wealth Fund (Amendment) Bill, 2026** remains before the Senate Standing Committee on Finance and Revenue, a governance overhaul the IMF is expected to scrutinise when its fourth EFF/third RSF review mission arrives this month, with Pakistan tracking to meet six of seven quantitative targets. August CPI jumped to **11.15% y/y** from July's four-month low of 9.2%, the SBP's policy rate stays at 11.5% (held since 27 July), 6-month KIBOR sits at 11.86%, and USD/PKR interbank has drifted to roughly 279.40 from Tuesday's 277.37 as the oil-driven import bill widens. Sources: [Business Recorder](#), [Business Recorder](#).

B. GCC & Middle East

Gulf oil benchmarks surged as the US-Iran conflict intensified around the Strait of Hormuz: Brent topped \$100/bbl for the first time since July (+3%) and WTI climbed to about \$96.2, even as OPEC+'s seven core producers — Saudi Arabia, Russia, Iraq, Kuwait, Kazakhstan, Algeria and Oman — held October quotas unchanged at their 6 September meeting, keeping the combined ceiling near 31.01m bpd and prioritising stability over volume. Away from the war premium, non-oil momentum held up well: the UAE's S&P Global PMI hit 55.3 in August, its best reading since December 2024, and Saudi Arabia's PMI rose to a six-month high of 53.8. Saudi's PIF continues executing its board-approved 2026–2030 strategy, having launched the Gulf Coast Development Company on 7 September to build an integrated coastal destination at Al-Khafji under the Vision 2030 tourism and urban-development push. Sources: [CNBC](#), [Arabian Business](#).

C. Global Intelligence

US equities fell for a third consecutive session Wednesday as rising oil prices and firm Treasury yields dented the outlook for corporate margins and consumer demand: the S&P 500 slipped 0.48% to 7,636.46, the Dow dropped 0.77% to 52,381.02 and the Nasdaq eased 0.64% to 26,253.34. The 10-year Treasury held near 4.80% and the 2-year near 4.40%, both close to multi-month highs, as traders weighed a coin-flip 16 September FOMC decision under Chair Kevin Warsh against Governor Waller's dovish lean. Congress continues working toward a stopgap funding bill to avert a shutdown at the 30 September fiscal-year deadline, with prediction markets pricing only modest odds of a lapse. Gold reclaimed \$4,400/oz (+1.1%) and silver rose to \$66.58/oz as haven demand built against the hawkish-Fed, oil-shock backdrop. Sources: [Investrade](#), [CNBC](#).

03 Legislative & Regulatory Tracker — Who Wins, Who Loses

Jurisdiction	Legislation / Policy Change	Affected Sector(s)	Net Impact & Strategic Outlook
Local — Pakistan	Sovereign Wealth Fund (Amendment) Bill, 2026 — still before the Senate Standing Committee on Finance and Revenue, tightening SWF governance, fiscal safeguards and disclosure ahead of the IMF's fourth EFF/third RSF review mission due this month.	State-owned enterprises, sovereign fund-held assets, banks	Wins: Investors and IMF stakeholders gain clearer governance and disclosure standards, supporting the case for the next EFF/RSF tranche. Losses: SWF-held state enterprises face tighter accountability and reporting obligations, raising near-term compliance costs.
Regional — GCC	OPEC+'s seven core producers held October output quotas unchanged at their 6 September meeting, keeping the combined ceiling near 31.01m bpd as Brent trades above \$100/bbl on Hormuz disruption.	Oil & gas majors, Gulf shipping/insurance, non-oil private sector	Wins: Producers capturing higher realised prices without added supply, and Saudi's PIF-backed diversification projects such as the Gulf Coast Development Company. Losses: Gulf shippers, insurers and energy importers exposed to a persistent Hormuz risk premium.
Global	US Congress continues negotiating a stopgap funding bill to avert a shutdown at the 30 September fiscal year-end, running alongside a finely balanced 16 September FOMC decision under new Fed Chair Kevin Warsh.	US equities, Treasuries, banks, technology	Wins: Risk assets and labour-sensitive sectors if a shutdown is averted and the Fed opts to hold. Losses: Growth and rate-sensitive names if a 25bp hike is delivered into an oil-driven inflation shock, and any funding lapse that disrupts data releases and federal operations.

04 The Day Ahead — KSE-100 Levels & Desk Stance

SUPPORT EST.

171,000

near Wednesday's intraday low of 171,802; deeper support at 169,500

PIVOT EST.

171,944

Wednesday's close

RESISTANCE EST.

173,174

Wednesday's intraday high; then Tuesday's close near 172,642

Wednesday's thinner volume (477.67m shares vs Tuesday's 722.62m) alongside a third consecutive loss suggests the nearly 3,400-point, three-day slide is losing some distribution intensity even as the proximate triggers — Brent above \$100/bbl on an unresolved US-Iran conflict, and a finely balanced 16 September FOMC — remain unresolved. With the index holding just above the 171,000 psychological floor, we'd stay defensive on broad beta into the FOMC while retaining selective exposure to banks and E&P names geared to a firmer oil tape, alongside SWF-adjacent names positioned to benefit from tighter governance ahead of the IMF's review mission. All levels are indicative desk estimates, not recommendations.

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